

I guess I'm a believer?

This past month, I've spent more time gaming on my mobile phone than on my PC. Never in my life did I think the day would come where I'd rather play on my phone than on a PC. Yet, here we are.

When I take a minute to think about it, it really shouldn't have come as this much of a surprise to me. It's been a while since mainstream AAA games have been making their way to mobile. It started back when PUBG Mobile and Fortnite made the jump to mobile and were pretty faithful adaptations of their PC versions. While there may or may not have been mobile versions of AAA games before that, these two, arguably, caused the biggest shift. Still, I refused to believe that I would succumb. Well, it happened anyway. Diablo Immortal released a few weeks ago and all of us got sucked in. **sigh**

While I can't stop myself from playing on mobile, it also reaffirmed my hate for mobile games. There was a reason I steered away from mobile games for so long. Before PUBG Mobile (which I've probably played more than the PC version at this point -*internal shrieking*-), I'd tried a few mobile games, and by tried, I mean I really invested some time into them. However, in pretty much all of those games, at some point it all slows down to a turtle's pace. You're left with two options, pay to speed things up, or just wait and slowly grind your way through.

This is doubly worse in mobile games of a competitive nature (we're talking primarily about mobile MMOs and the dreaded Gacha games, in this case). It's nice to think that you can beat paying players as a free player with hard work and dedication, but in most such mobile games it's simply impossible. There are features, benefits, and advantages that are available ONLY to the people who are willing to pay. You can pretty much forget about being competitive or even attempting to show up on the leaderboards. Those spots are reserved for the whales.

Of course, that's old news. Mobile games are rife with microtransactions and are as pay2win as can



–Manish “Trigger-Happy” Rajesh
SKOAR! Overlord | feedback@skoar.in

possibly be. It was the same when I played them before, and it's the same (and probably worse) now with Diablo Immortal. It's sad because the game is actually really good. That's the only reason I keep going back to it. I enjoy playing the game. But as a principle, I refuse to spend a single rupee on this game. What's worse is that I know me not spending a single rupee means absolutely nothing. Blizzard reported that Diablo Immortal brought in \$24 million in the first two weeks of its release. Their abusive and aggressive microtransactions are working, so there's no reason for them to stop. There's no reason for the industry to stop, and unfortunately, it's going to get a lot worse as more companies start making the shift to mobile, because there's simply more money to be made. *